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MARCH 1, 1979

PRESIDENT GASS, Mr. Wax OFFICERS AND MEMBERS OF THE NORTH SHORE, JEWISH HISTORICAL SOCIETY, INVITED GUESTS -- AND FRIENDS -- SHALOM! AND I MIGHT ADD, SALUD, MAZAL BUENO QUE TOPAS, NO SOLAMENTO ESTE DIA, PERO CADA DIA, SIEMPRE. (ENGLISH TRANSLATION) GREETINGS: MAY GOOD FORTUNE FOLLOW YOU, NOT ONLY THIS DAY, BUT EVERYDAY -- ALWAYS.

LADIES AND GENTLEMEN, I'M JOE GIBELY, PRESIDENT OF THE CONGREGATION TIFERETH ISRAEL (SEPHARDIC). OUR HOUSE OF WORSHIP IS LOCATED IN PEABODY AND OUR CONGREGANTS ARE FROM THE ENTIRE NORTHSHORE. CONGREGATION TIFERETH ISRAEL WAS FOUNDED FEB. 15, 1922 AND 7 YEARS AGO WE CELEBRATED OUR GOLDEN ANNIVERSARY.

SOME OF THE MOST ASKED QUESTIONS ABOUT OUR SMALL BUT EXTREMELY CLOSE GROUP ARE: WHO ARE THE SEPHARDIC JEWS? WHERE DID THEY COME FROM? HOW DID THEY GET HERE? BEFORE ANSWERING THESE QUESTIONS, I THINK IT'S IMPORTANT THAT WE KNOW THE MEANING OF THE TERMS "INQUISITION" AND "MARRANOS" -- TERMS THAT WE SEPHARDIC JEWS ARE CLOSELY ASSOCIATED WITH.

INQUISITION

IN 1464, AT THE CONCORDAT OF MEDINA DEL CAMPO, SPAIN, IT WAS DECIDED TO ESTABLISH AN INQUIRY INTO THE CONDUCT OF THE NEW CHRISTIANS. IN 1478 AFTER SOME CONVERSOS (CONVERTS OR JEWS TURNED CHRISTIANS OR MARRANOS) WERE FOUND CELEBRATING A PASSOVER CEREMONY, THREE PERSONS WERE EMPOWERED BY THE CHURCH WITH COMPLETE JURISDICTION OVER HERETICS. THIS CONSTITUTED THE FORMAL ESTABLISHMENTS OF THE INQUISITION. MATTERS BEGAN TO MOVE FORWARD IN 1480.

THE CITY OF SEVILLE WAS ONE OF THE MAIN CENTERS OF CONVERSOS UNDER THE LEADERSHIP OF DIEGO DE SUSAN, A WEALTHY MERCHANT. THE NEW CHRISTIANS DECIDED TO RESIST THE INQUISITION. BUT THE BEAUTIFUL DAUGHTER OF DIEGO DISCLOSED THE SECRET TO HER CHRISTIAN LOVER, WHO THEREUPON REVEALED IT TO THE INQUISITORS. WITH A POSITIVE WEAPON IN THEIR HANDS THE INQUISITORS

Breif History of Sephardic Jews
Donated by Joe Gibely (12 pgs

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NOW MOVED AGAINST THE CONVERSOS OF SEVILLE. WEALTHY AND HONORABLE CITIZENS WERE ARRESTED, TRIED AND CONDEMNED TO DEATH.

EARLY IN 1481 THE FIRST AUTO DA FÉ TOOK PLACE IN SEVILLE, SIX MEN AND WOMEN WERE BURNED ALIVE. ON THE SECOND OCCASION DIEGO HIMSELF WAS EXECUTED. A PERMANENT PYRE WAS NOW CONSTRUCTED JUST OUTSIDE THE CITY WALLS FOR THE EXECUTIONS BY BURNING. MANY MARRANOS FLED TO NEIGHBORING TERRITORIES, BUT WERE REMANDED BY THE NOBILITY AT THE URGING OF THE AUTHORITIES. THEIR PROPERTY WAS CONFISCATED, MOST OF THE PROCEEDS GOING TO THE CROWN. THE PUBLIC BURNING OF SECRET JEWS CONTINUED WITH REGULARITY AND SOON BECAME POPULAR SPECTACLES. AT EACH OF THESE PUBLIC JUDGEMENTS THE SENTENCES OF THE ACCUSED WERE PRONOUNCED AND PUNISHMENT - WHICH INCLUDED FLOGGING, IMPRISONMENT, BANISHMENT, OR DEATH BY BURNING -- WAS CARRIED OUT. THE PROMISE OF FREE PARDON FOR FULL CONFESSION ENCOURAGED WIDESPREAD DENUNCIATION. JEWS, PARTICULARLY FORMER SYNAGOGUE OFFICIALS, WERE ENLISTED AT PAIN OF EXCOMMUNICATION TO EXPOSE ALL THEY KNEW. AT LEAST 2000 OF THESE "SPECTACLES" TOOK PLACE IN THE PENINSULA AND ITS DEPENDENCIES AND IN ALL SOME 400,000 PERSONS WERE TRIED BY THE INQUISITION IN SPAIN AND PORTUGAL DURING THE THREE AND A HALF CENTURIES OF ITS EXISTENCE: OF THESE ABOUT 30,000 WERE PUT TO DEATH. IT WAS NOT UNTIL THE EIGHTEENTH CENTURY THAT THE ACTIVITY OF THE INQUISITION BEGAN TO DIMINISH, AND BY THAT TIME IT HAD DONE ITS WORK SO EFFECTIVELY THAT VICTIMS WERE DIFFICULT TO FIND.

THE INSTITUTION OF INQUISITION WAS FINALLY ABOLISHED IN 1834. ——— MARRANOS

ORDINARY LAYMENT ASSOCIATE THE WORD "INQUISITION" TO EVENTS OCCURING IN SPAIN AND PORTUGAL IN THE LATE 1400'S, BUT IN REALITY THERE WERE OTHER SUCH TRAGEDIES WHERE THE JEWS EITHER HAD TO EMBRACE ANOTHER RELIGION OR BE DRIVEN OUT, OR EVEN KILLED. AT THE CLOSE OF THE 13TH CENTURY, ANGEVIN RULERS IN NAPLES FORCIBLY CONVERTED JEWS WHO UNDER THE NAME OF

"NEOFITI" HAD RETAINED A CRYPTO-JEWISH EXISTANCE FOR OVER THREE CENTURIES. THEIR SECRET FIDELITY TO JUDAISM WAS ONE REASON FOR THE ESTABLISHMENT OF AN INQUISITION IN NAPLES IN THE SIXTEENTH CENTURY. THERE WERE SIMILAR CASES IN THE MOSLEM WORLD: FOR INSTANCE THE DAGGATUN OF THE SAHARA. IT IS KNOWN THAT IN SPAIN THERE WERE CASES OF CRYPTO-JUDAISM IN ROMAN TIMES.

OUTWARDLY, THESE MARRANOS, AS THEY WERE KNOWN IN SPANISH WERE CHRISTIANS; INWARDLY THEY WERE JEWS. THEIR DISBELIEF IN THE DOGMAS OF THE CHURCH WAS NOTORIOUS. THEY KEPT TRADITIONAL JEWISH CEREMONIES; SOME WOULD EAT ONLY KOSHER MEAT; USUALLY THEY MARRIED EXCLUSIVELY AMONG THEMSELVES; THEY CONSORTED WITH EX-CORELIGIONISTS AND SOMETIMES FURTIVELY ATTENDED SYNAGOGUE. WORST OF ALL IN THE EYES OF THE CHURCH, THEY TRANSMITTED THEIR DISBELIEF TO THEIR CHILDREN.

WITH THE REMOVAL OF RELIGIOUS DISABILITIES UPON CONVERSION, ALL WALKS OF LIFE BECAME OFFICIALLY OPEN TO THE MARRANOS. IN SPAIN, THEY WERE IN EVERY PROFESSION; LAW, GOVERNMENT, THE ARMY, THE UNIVERSITIES, THE CHURCH ITSELF. IN TIME THEY ALL BUT DOMINATED SPANISH LIFE. WITHIN A FEW GENERATIONS ALMOST EVERY ARISTOCRATIC FAMILY HAD SOME JEWISH BLOOD IN IT. THE REVIVAL OF VERNACULAR LITERATURE AT THE COURT OF JUAN II IN ARAGON WAS IN LARGE PART DUE TO THE GENIUS OF PERSONS OF JEWISH BLOOD. FERNANDO DE ROJAS CONSIDERED ONE OF THE GREAT CLASSICAL WRITERS OF THE SPANISH TONGUE WAS OF JEWISH DESCENT. SUCH PERSONS WERE USUALLY CALLED "NEW CHRISTIANS" TO DISTINGUISH THEM FROM THOSE WHO WERE BORN CHRISTIANS. POPULARLY THEY WERE KNOWN AS "MARRANOS" -- AN OLD SPANISH TERM DATING TO THE EARLY MIDDLE AGES AND MEANING "SWINE". THE TERM EXPRESSES ALL THE CONTEMPT WHICH THE ORDINARY SPANIARD FELT FOR THE INSINCERE NEOPHYTES BY WHOM HE HAD RAPIDLY BECOME SURROUNDED.

THUS, DESPITE THE ELEMENTS, OF SYNCRETISM THAT CREPT INTO THEIR OBSERVANCE, THE MARRANOS HELD ON FIERCELY TO THE FAITH OF THEIR FATHERS -- OR THAT PART OF IT WHICH THEY WERE ABLE TO REMEMBER AND RECONSTRUCT. WITHOUT

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BOOKS, WITHOUT SCHOOLS, WITHOUT LEADERSHIP, AND ABOVE ALL IN CONSTANT DANGER OF BEING DISCOVERED, THEY HELD ON--A T WHAT COST IT IS IMPOSSIBLE TO COMPUTE BUT TO WHAT END IT WOULD BE BLASPHEMY TO QUESTION. ———

WE, THE SEPHARDIC JEWS OF THE CONGREGATION TIFERETH ISRAEL, ALSO KNOWN AS SPANIOLS, ARE JEWS OF SPANISH DESCENT, A TERM APPLIED ESPECIALLY TO THE DESCENDANTS OF THE EXILES AND REFUGEES FROM SPAIN AND PORTUGAL. I CANNOT, WITH ACCURACY, TELL YOU IN WHAT YEAR OUR ANCESTORS WERE FORCED TO FLEE SPAIN, BECAUSE LARGE SCALE MIGRATION OF SPANISH JEWS COMMENCED WITH THE MASSACRES AND PERSECUTIONS OF 1391, WHICH WAS FOLLOWED BY FORCIBLE MASS CONVERSIONS IN 1412 TO 1415. THEN, OF COURSE, WE HAD THE TOTAL EXPULSION OF SPANISH JEWRY IN 1492, FOLLOWED BY PARALLEL ACTION IN PORTUGAL In 1497. AT THIS POINT IN HISTORY THERE WAS AN OVERFLOW OF JEWISH MIGRATION INTO ALL PARTS OF THE OTTOMAN EMPIRE (INCLUDING NORTH AFRICA AND ASIA MINOR) AND ALSO TO ITALY. OTHER GROUPS ESTABLISHED COMMUNITIES IN GERMANY, DENMARK, HOLLAND, ENGLAND, AUSTRIA AND HUNGARY. OUTSTANDING CENTERS OF SEPHARDIC INFLUENCE WERE CONSTANTINOPLE, NOW CALLED ISTANBUL, SALONICA, (GREECE), JERUSALEM AND SAFED IN PALESTINE, NOW ISRAEL: CAIRO, IN EGYPT, AND VENICE, AMSTERDAM, BORDEAUX AND LONDON, IN WESTERN EUROPE. IT IS PROBABLY SAFE TO SAY OUR ANCESTORS FLED SPAIN IN THE LATE 1400'S AND SETTLED IN CONSTANTINOPLE (NEE ISTANBUL) WHERE THEY REMAINED FOR APPROXIMATELY 500 YEARS.

STARTING IN 1911 AND IN QUICK ORDER THEREAFTER LEON ESKENAS, MYER BENATER, THEIR WIVES REBECCA AND REGINA, AND THE FOLLOWING FAMILIES----GIBELY, ESKENAZI, YONIS, HASDAY, LEON, HAVIAN, PERNITCHI, SAVY, FERMON AND ERERA MIGRATED TO THE UNITED STATES AND SETTLED IN THE SALEM-PEABODY AREA. FROM THIS SMALL BEGINNING EMERGED THE PRESENT COMMUNITY KNOWN AS THE CONGREGATION TIFERETH ISRAEL. ———————

I THINK ONE OF THE MOST AMAZING THINGS THAT WE SEPHARDIC JEWS POSSESS IS

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OUR LADINO. IN ALL PARTS OF THE WORLD WE HAVE RETAINED TENACIOUSLY OUR OWN SPANISH (OR PORTUGUESE) IDIOM, LADINO, AS THE LANGUAGE OF SPEECH AND AS A LITERARY MEDIUM, SECONDARY TO HEBREW. UNLIKE YIDDISH, LADINO IS A CLOSE REPLICA OF THE NATIVE LANGUAGE, IN THIS CASE CASTILIAN. THROUGHOUT THEIR WANDERINGS, THE SPANISH JEWS AND THEIR DESCENDANTS NEVER LOST THEIR CONSCIOUSNESS OF ARISTOCRACY. THE SUFFERINGS OF THE EXILE AND THE TRAGIC EXPERIENCES OF THE MARRANOS DID NOT BREAK THEIR SPIRIT.

OUR PARENTS, WHEN THEY LIVED IN TURKEY, SPOKE FIVE OR SIX LANGUAGES FLUENTLY BECAUSE OF THE COSMOPOLITAN MAKEUP OF THE COMMUNITY. IN CONSTANTINOPLE YOU WOULD HAVE A GREEK SECION, A SYRIAN SECTION, AN ARMENIAN SECTION AND SO ON. IN ADDITION TO TURKISH (THE COUNTRY OF ORIGIN) THE DOMINANT LANGUAGE SPOKEN IN THE HOME AND IN THE SYNAGOGUE WAS LADINO (WHICH CAN BEST BE DESCRIBED AS A MIXED-UP SPANISH WITH A MIXTURE OF TURKISH, GREEK, AND ENGLISH PLUS A LOT OF IMPROVISATIONS) TO WIT: FIRST SOME TURKISH--IN OUR LADINO WE REFER TO THE WORD "STORE" (SHOP OR SELLING ESTABLISHMENT)---AS "BACAL" WHEN IN REALITY, THOSE OF YOU WHO UNDERSTAND SPANISH KNOW THAT "TIENDA" OR "BOTEGA" CAN BE PROPERLY USED. LAMB CHOPS ARE CALLED "BREEZOLAS" INSTEAD OF "CHULETAS DE CORDERO".

A POPULAR EXCLAMATION AMONG MOSLEMS IS "MASHALLAH" (WHATEVER GOD (ALLAH) WISHES.) TO THIS DAY WE SEPHARDIC JEWS STILL USE THIS EXPRESSION, IT IS USED BY US TO INDICATE APPROVAL.

AN EXAMPLE OF GREEK IN OUR LADINO IS THE WORD FOR STRINGBEANS--"FASULAS" WHEN IT SHOULD BE "HABICHUELAS VERDE"; STUFFED GRAPE LEAVES IS "YAPRAKAS" WHEN IT SHOULD BE "HOJAS DE UVA HENCHIRAS". THERE ARE OF COURSE DIFFERENT DIALECTS WHERE YOU CAN USE MORE THAN ONE WORD TO EXPRESS ANOTHER. A COUPLE OF EXAMPLES THAT COME TO MIND ARE: FOR "DOLLARS" WE CAN USE "PESOS" OR "DOLARES": FOR "DOCTOR" WE CAN USE "MEDICO" OR "DOCTOR". RED CAN BE

EITHER "ROJO" OR "COLORADO". AS FOR IMPROVISATIONS DIG THE FOLLOWING: OUR PARENTS WHEN THEY CAME TO THIS COUNTRY FROM TURKEY HEARD THE WORD "FIX". "FIX", OF COURSE TO BE USED IN THE SAME SENSE AS THE WORD REPAIR. SO THE SPANIOLS ADDED AN A TO FIX SO THAT IT BECAME "FIXA". NOW TO SAY "FIX THE CAR" WE CAME UP WITH "FIXA EL CARO OR AUTOMOVIL. THE PROPER WORD FOR REPAIR OR FIX IS "ARREGLAR". ANOTHER ONE WE SEPHARDIM MADE UP IS FOR THE WORD "WATCH"---FOR EXAMPLE: WATCH OUT! WE CONVENIENTLY ADDED "EA" TO IT SO THAT IT BECAME "WATCHEA". THE REAL SPANISH FOR "WATCH" OR LOOK AFTER OR TAKE CARE OF IS CUIDAR. FOR THE WORD "ASH TRAY" WE SAY "CHENEE DE CIGAROS" WHICH LITERALLY MEANS "DISH OF OR "FOR CIGARETTES", WHEN THE CASTILIAN OR OLD SPANISH WORD FOR ASH TRAY IS CENICERO.

WHEN THE MOHAMMEDANS, WHO WERE MORE LIBERAL THAN THE CHRISTIAN PRINCES, RULED SPAIN THEY FREQUENTLY APPOINTED JEWS AS MINISTERS, AMBASSADORS, TAX COLLECTORS, OR COURT PHYSICIANS. HASDEI IBN SHAPRUT BORN 915-DIED 990 WAS VIZIER UNDER CALIPH ABD-AL-RAHMAN III OF CORDOVA. SITTING IN OUR AUDIENCE HERE TONIGHT IS A SEPHARDIC JEW BY THE SAME NAME OF HASDAY. HIS FULL NAME IS ISAAC HASDAY AND HE IS THE VICE-PRESIDENT OF OUR CONGREGATION. IN CHRISTIAN SPAIN, THE APOSTATE CAULUS DE SANTA MARIA (ORIGINALLY "SOLOMON HALEVI", (BORN 1351 DIED 1435) BECAME PRIVY COUNCILLOR TO KING HENRY III OF CASTILE. A LONG TIME MEMBER OF OUR CONGREGATION, NOW DECEASED, HAD PRACTICALLY THE SAME NAME "SOLOMON LEVY". IN GREECE MANY SEPHARDIC JEWS BECAME MINISTERS: ONE OF THEM WAS CALLED M. BESSANTCHI. BESSANTCHI WAS MY MOTHER'S MAIDEN NAME. IN THE LATE 1800'S BEHOR ASHKENAZI EFFENDI WAS A DEPUTY IN TURKEY. ONE OF OUR MEMBERS IS JOSHUA ESKENAZI. ANOTHER DEPUTY ELECTED IN 1908 WAS EMANUEL CARASSO. I HAVE A BROTHER-IN-LAW BY THE SAME SURNAME CARASSO. I CAN'T SAY FOR SURE, BUT ITS POSSIBLE WE ARE DIRECT DESCENDENTS OF THESE FAMOUS AND HIGHLY RESPECTED JEWS OF YESTERYEAR.

SEPHARDIC JUDAISM, WHICH WAS AND STILL IS, IN MANY CONGREGATIONS THROUGHOUT THE UNITED STATES, ORTHODOX MUST BE DESCRIBED BY ME, IN REGARDS TO OUR CONGREGATION, TIFERETH ISRAEL, A MIXTURE OF ORTHODOX AND REFORM. THE MOST SOLEMN PORTIONS OF OUR PRAYERS ARE RETAINED WITH VERY LITTLE EXCLUSIONS. THIS IS TRUE OF ALL THE MAJOR HOLIDAYS. EVEN OUR MELDADOS (YAHRZEITS) HAVE NO SHORT-CUTS. IT'S A FULL 25 TO 30 MINUTE SERVICE. THE MAJOR CHANGES THAT HAVE OCCURED OVER THE YEARS INCLUDE: THE CUSTOM OF OFFERINGS AT THE ALTER DURING THE HIGH HOLIDAYS WHICH ARE NOW RECITED IN ENGLISH AND SPANISH, AND MOST OF THE PRAYERS FOR ALL HOLIDAYS AND YAHRZEITS ARE RECITED BOTH IN HEBREW AND ENGLISH WHICH ENABLES EVERY MEMBER OF OUR CONGREGATION TO FULLY UNDERSTAND EVERY PART OF THE SERVICE.

AN IMPORTANT ASPECT OF OUR SYNAGOGUE SERVICES DURING THE HIGH HOLIDAYS INVOLVES THE AUCTIONING OF MITZVOTHS or Aliyahs. PRIOR TO THE CEREMONIES RELATED TO THE REMOVAL OF THE TORAH SCROLLS FROM THE ARK, I, AS THE SEXTON, AUCTION THE FOLLOWING MITZVOTHS: (Ex. of Span. in our services)

1. "QUANTO DUN POR LA PETIHAH?"
   (WHAT IS OFFERED) TO OPEN THE DOORS OF THE ARK.
2. "QUANTO DUN POR EL SEFER REESHON?
   (WHAT IS OFFERED) TO CARRY THE FIRST SEFER TORAH.
3. "QUANTO DUN POR EL SEFER SHENEE?"
   (WHAT IS OFFERED) TO CARRY THE SECOND SEFER TORAH.
4. "QUANTO DUN POR METER LOS RIMONIM?"
   (WHAT IS OFFERED) TO PLACE THE ORNAMENTAL SILVER BELLS ON THE SEFER TORAHS.
5. "QUANTO DUN POR LA HAKAMAH?"
   (WHAT IS OFFERED) TO LIFT THE OPENED TORAH SCROLL AND TURN IT AROUND SO THE WORSHIPPER'S can SEE THE TEXT BEFORE THE READING.
6. "QUANTO DUN PARA AZER LA GELILAH?"

(WHAT IS OFFERED) TO REMOVE THE BELLS, BAND AND CLOAK OF THE SEFER TORAH.

7. "QUANTO DUN POR MELDAR LA HAFTARAH?"

(WHAT IS OFFERED) TO READ THE HAFTARAH. (A PRAYER FOR A DEPARTED RELATIVE.)

AS YOU KNOW, IT IS CONSIDERED A GREAT HONOR TO BE CALLED TO THE SEFER DURING THE HIGH HOLIDAYS, AND IN MOST SYNAGOGUES AND TEMPLES ONLY A SELECT FEW ARE SO HONORED. BUT IN OUR CONGREGATION TIFERETH ISRAEL, ALL ADULT MALES ARE HONORED BY BEING CALLED TO THE SEFER. THERE ARE TWO UNIQUE THINGS THAT HAPPEN WHEN A DESIGNATED CONGREGANT IS CALLED. THE MOMENT HIS NAME IS CALLED ALL HIS YOUNGER RELATIVES RISE AND REMAIN STANDING WHILE HE RECITES HIS BLESSINGS BEFORE AND AFTER THE TORAH IS READ. THIS SHOWS RESPECT FOR SOMEONE OLDER THAN YOU. ALSO AS HE MAKES HIS WAY TO THE READER'S DESK OTHER WORSHIPPERS CALL OUT TO HIM: Bekhavo "BEKHAVOD", OR, "IN HONOR".

ON THE ANNIVERSARY OF THE DEATH OF AN IMMEDIATE RELATIVE THE SURVIVING RELATIVES OBSERVE THE "MELDADO", OR READING, OR THE YAHRZEIT. FAMILY AND FRIENDS ARE INVITED TO ATTEND. AFTER THE SERVICES THE HOSTESS AND OTHER WOMEN PASS AROUND PLATES OF FOOD FOR THE GUESTS. THESE WOULD INCLUDE SUCH THINGS AS RAISINS, HARD-BOILED EGGS, IMPORTED KASERI CHEESE, BLACK OLIVES, ROLLS AND WHISKEY.

THERE ARE TWO THINGS THAT HAVE OCCURED IN MY LIFETIME THAT HAS MADE ME HAPPY. I'M HAPPY BECAUSE WHETHER YOU ARE A JEW IN EUROPE, AFRICA, AMERICA, ANYWHERE, THE PRONUNCIATION OF HEBREW HAS BEEN UNIFIED. WE HERE, AND ALL FUTURE GENERATIONS, WILL BE CHANTING BAHROOCH ATTA (Atheni) ETC. THIS ALSO INCLUDES THE 25,000 FALASHAS, (BLACK JEWS OF ETHIOPIA,) PROBABLY THE OLDEST JEWISH COMMUNITY IN EXISTENCE, WHO'S WAY OF LIFE STILL RETAIN THE PASTORAL QUALITY OF BIBLICAL DAYS. I'M HAPPY ALSO BECAUSE OF THE CREATION OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL IN 1948. I DON'T BELIEVE I HAVE TO TELL YOU WHY--I'M SURE YOU ALL FEEL THE SAME MOVING SPIRIT.

THE FIRST JEWISH ARTIST WAS MYER MYERS, A SILVERSMITH, WHO WAS BORN IN N.Y. IN 1723. (SEPHARDIC) EXAMPLES OF HIS WORK MAY BE SEEN IN MUSEUMS, SYNAGOGUES, CHURCHES, AND PRIVATE COLLECTIONS. ALL HIS OBJECTS, EXQUISITE CHANUKAH LAMPS, SPICE BOXES, AND CEREMONIAL OBJECTS CARRY HIS TRADEMARK M.M.

THE FIRST JEWISH SCHOOL, CALLED YESHIVAH MINHAT AREB WAS ESTABLISHED IN 1728 IN NEW YORK. (SEPHARDIC)

THE FIRST JEWISH SOLDIER TO SERVE IN THE ARMED FORCES OF THE NORTH AMERICAN LANDS WAS THE "MARRANO" HERNANDO ALONSO WHO FOUGHT UNDER CORTEZ IN THE EARLY 1500'S. HE DIED IN 1528.

THE FIRST JEWISH INTERCOLONIAL FURRIER WAS HYMAN LEVY - 1760 (SEPHARDIC). ONE OF HIS EMPLOYEES WAS JOHN JACOB ASTOR, ANCESTOR OF THE FAMOUS ASTORS OF TODAY.

THE OLDEST SYNAGOGUE BUILDING IN AMERICA STILL IN EXISTENCE IS THE TOURO SYNAGOGUE, WHICH WAS BUILT IN 1763 IN NEWPORT, R.I. (SEPHARDIC).

THE FIRST JEWISH CLUB IN THE UNITED STATES ORGANIZED IN 1761 WAS FOUNDED IN NEWPORT, R.I. THIS SOCIAL CLUB WAS ORGANIZED BY THE SEPHARDIC MERCHANTS.

THE FIRST JEWISH MERCHANT PRINCE OF THE UNITED STATES 1767 WAS AARON LOPEZ (A SEPHARDIC JEW) WHO OWNED IN WHOLE OR IN PART THIRTY TRANS-ATLANTIC SHIPS AND OVER ONE HUNDRED COAST WISE VESSELS.

THE FIRST AMERICAN BORN JEWISH CLERGYMAN WAS THE REVEREND GERSHOM MENDEZ SEIXAS. THIS SEPHARDIC MAN WAS BORN IN NEW YORK IN 1745 AND BECAME A RABBI IN 1768, OF THE CONGREGATION SHEARITH ISRAEL.

10 — THE FIRST JEW IN AMERICA TO GIVE HIS LIFE FOR HIS COUNTRY WAS FRANCIS SALVADOR WHO WAS KILLED IN 1776. (KEOWEE RIVER, SOUTH CAROLINA) TWO YEARS PRIOR TO HIS DEATH SALVADOR WAS ELECTED TO THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF SOUTH CAROLINA, THE FIRST JEW IN AMERICAN HISTORY AND PROBABLY THE FIRST JEW IN THE MODERN WORLD TO SERVE AS AN ELECTIVE OFFICER. HE WAS A SEPHARDIC JEW.

— THE FIRST JEWISH MAJOR WAS BENJAMIN NONES OF THE CONTINENTAL ARMY IN 1780. THIS SEPHARDIC OFFICER COMMANDED A BATTALION OF FOUR HUNDRED MEN, FANCIFULLY CALLED THE "HEBREW LEGION", EITHER BECAUSE OF ITS COMMANDER OR ON ACCOUNT OF THE LARGE NUMBER OF JEWISH ENLISTEES.

— THE FIRST JEW TO FOUND A SETTLEMENT IN THE UNITED STATES WAS AARON LEVY. (SEPHARDIC) IT HAPPENED ON OCT. 5, 1786 AND THE TOWN IS AARONSBERG, PENNSYLVANIA.

N THE FIRST JEWISH BOOKDEALER IN AMERICA IN 1791 WAS BENJAMIN GOMEZ, A SEPHARDIC, WHOSE FATHER WAS LUIZ GOMEZ, ONE OF NEW YORK'S PRINCIPAL MERCHANTS.

N THE FIRST COPPER ROLLING MILL NAMED THE SOHO COPPER MILL WAS BUILT BY HARMON HENDRICKS IN BELLEVILLE, NEW JERSEY IN 1812. THIS SEPHARDIC OWNED BUSINESS SURVIVED FOR 127 YEARS, WHEN IN 1939 THE PLANT WAS PURCHASED BY THE ANDREW JERGENS CO.

— THE FIRST JEWISH DENTIST WAS DR. BENJAMIN A. RODRIGUEZ OF CHARLESTON, SOUTH CAROLINA IN 1832. YES, HE WAS A SEPHARDIC JEW. THROUGHOUT HIS CAREER DR. RODRIGUEZ WAS OFTEN CALLED UPON AS LECTURER BEFORE IMPORTANT DENTAL SOCIETIES AND HIS OUTSTANDING WORK WAS QUOTED IN STANDARD TEXTBOOKS ON DENTAL SURGERY.

— THE FIRST JEWISH PHILANTHROPIST IN THE UNITED STATES WAS JUDAH TOURO SON OF RABBI ISAAC TOURO, THE FIRST MINISTER OF THE NEWPORT CONGREGATION.

in Rhode Island

Next to "This extremely charitable —

IN 1976 THE UNITED STATES CELEBRATED ITS BI-CENTENIAL (200 YEARS).

11. Also IN 1976 THE CITY OF SALEM CELEBRATED ITS 350th BIRTHDAY AND THE FIRST JEWISH POLICE OFFICER IN ITS HISTORY IS MORRIS GIBELEY. A SEPHARDIC JEW WHO RECENTLY RETIRED AFTER 35 YEARS SERVICE. THE CONGREGATION TIFERETH ISRAEL IS EXTREMELY PROUD OF MORRIS BECAUSE HE IS A MEMBER OF OUR CONGREGATION. → Next to: "Remember Ladie

THIS EXTREMELY CHARITABLE SEPHARDIC JEW DIED IN 1854 AT THE AGE OF 79. HE BUILT THE FIRST FREE PUBLIC LIBRARY IN NEW ORLEANS WHICH WAS THE FIRST FREE PUBLIC LIBRARY IN THE WORLD; FOUNDED THE TOURO INFIRMARY, ONE OF THE SOUTH'S BEST HOSPITALS: AND ERECTED THE SHAKESPEARE ALMS HOUSE FOR THE POOR. THE TOURO SYNAGOGUE AND TOURO STREET ALL PERPETUATE HIS NAME IN NEW ORLEANS. IN HIS WILL HE LEFT FROM $2000. TO $5000 TO EVERY SYNAGOGUE IN AMERICA THEN IN EXISTENCE. HEBREW SCHOOLS, HOSPIT AND RELIEF SOCIETIES IN AMERICA AND PALESTINE WERE ALSO LEFT A SHARE OF HIS GREAT FORTUNE. HE HAD ALSO DONATED A CHURCH BUILDING TO A NEW ORLEANS CHRISTIAN CONGREGATION. → next to " In 1976 the U.S. -

REMEMBER LADIES AND GENTLEMEN, THE MINOR DIFFERENCES WHICH WE PRACTICE AND OBSERVE, AND THIS INCLUDES ALL JEWS, BE THEY SEPHARDIM, ESHKENAZIM, ORTHODOX, CONSERVATIVE, REFORM, OR WHATEVER, ARE IN REALITY WHAT UNITE US IN A STRENGTH THAT CANNOT BE PUT INTO WORDS. IT'S AN INNER FEELING.

PRESIDENT GASS: ON BEHALF OF THE CONGREGATION TIFERETH ISRAEL, I WOULD LIKE TO PRESENT TO YOU AND THE NORTH SHORE JEWISH HISTORICAL SOCIETY THESE TWO SEPHARDIC PRAYER BOOKS. THEY ILLUSTRATE WHAT I LIKE TO CALL THE PAST AND THE PRESENT. THE OLD BOOK WAS PRINTED IN VIENNA, AUSTRIA FOR THE SEPHARDIC COMMUNITIES OF EUROPE AND IS 119 YEARS OLD. THE NEW BOOK IS PRINTED IN NEW YORK AND IS IN ENGLISH AS WELL AS HEBREW AND IT IS A CURRANT EDITION.

IN CLOSING---DIEGO RIVERA, MEXICO'S GREATEST ARTIST AND ONE OF THE WORLD'S OUTSTANDING PAINTERS, UPON DISCOVERING THAT HIS PATERNAL GRANDMOTHER INES ACOSTA WAS JEWISH PROMPTLY WROTE A LETTER TO THE MEXICO CITY B'NAI BRITH. IN THIS LETTER DATED OCT. 22, 1942, HE CONSIDERED IT: QUOTE "AN HONOR TO HAVE JEWISH BLOOD IN HIS VEINS, BECAUSE THE JEWS, IN PROPORTION TO THEIR NUMBER, HAVE CONTRIBUTED INTELLECTUALLY MORE THAN ANY OTHER ETHNOGRAPHIC GROUP TOWARD THE

CONSTRUCTION OF WHAT IS ACTUALLY CALLED CIVILIZATION" END QUOTE.

WHY IS THIS STATEMENT FROM DIEGO RIVERA SO IMPORTANT? WHY DOES IT MAKE US JEWS SO PROUD? DIEGO RIVERA WAS A CHRISTIAN? ————

On behalf of the Congregation Tifereth Israel I WANT TO THANK THE OFFICERS AND MEMBERS OF THE NORTH SHORE JEWISH HISTORICAL SOCIETY FOR INVITING ME HERE THIS EVENING TO TALK ABOUT OUR LITTLE SEPHARDIC "SHULE" AND TO TELL YOU SOMETHING ABOUT ITS HISTORY, ITS MEMBERS, ITS CUSTOMS AND ITS FOOD.

SPEAKING OF FOOD THE LADIES AUXILIARY OF OUR CONGREGATION WELCOMES YOU TO THE TABLE ON MY LEFT. TRY SOME SPINACH PIE, STUFFED GRAPE VINE LEAVES AND SOME OF THE OTHER SEPHARDIC DELICICIES. I KNOW YOU WILL ENJOY THEM.

LADIES AND GENTLEMEN FOR YOUR CONSIDERATE ATTENTION,

MUCHAS GRACIAS.

THANK YOU.